

The Democrats agreed to recognize Hayes as president. In exchange, the Republicans promised to pull Federal troops out of the South—where the soldiers' duties had included protecting the rights of Black and Republican voters. They would also relinquish control of South Carolina, Florida, and Louisiana to the Democrats. For their part, Southern Democrats were to respect the civil rights of Black Americans—a promise that they failed to keep. The year 1877, therefore, saw the end of Reconstruction of the South. Black voting and office holding continued in some places into the 1890s, but for the most part the United States entered a dark chapter of segregation that lasted for a century.

264,292 Democratic candidate Samuel J. Tilden's lead in the popular vote over his Republican rival Rutherford B. Hayes in the presidential election of 1876. A total of 8.4 million votes were cast.